

ActionScript 3.0

ActionScript 3.0, at its core, is a language based on the ECMAScript4 just like the very popular language used in web browsers JavaScript. ECMAScript 4 basically dictates all of ActionScript's basic syntax.

AS3 has very good support for common object-oriented constructs such as classes, objects, and interfaces. It also has Runtime type checking and Optional compile time type checking. It includes dynamic features such as runtime creation of new constructor functions and variables. It offers direct support for XML as a built-in data type. All Flash client runtimes that support ActionScript 3.0 share the features of the core language in common.

There are two primary routes you can take while handling ActionScript. The first method which is more commonly used by earlier Flash developers is to simply put in your ActionScript directly into the timeline. In this method, having a separate layer in your timeline that is primarily dedicated just for working with ActionScript is considered a good practice. Adobe recommends that ActionScript label be labelled as 'Actions.' By locking the Actions layer in the timeline you can save yourself the trouble



ActionScript 3 Code Snippets in Flash CS5

of accidentally adding movie clips into it. The other method of coding in ActionScript and inserting it into your Flash files is by using a Class file. While inserting a Class file you can now specify both public and private classes. Using the keyword 'Private' will restrict the access of the attribute you defined to just that class and it will not be shared with other classes. This is very useful when you develop instructions that need to be executed privately in a closed secure environment.